

University Interscholastic League
Literary Criticism Contest • Invitational B • 2026

Part 1: Knowledge of Literary Terms and of Literary History

30 items (1 point each)

1. An expression used during informal everyday conversation but not accepted universally in formal speech or writing is known as a(n)
 - A) colloquialism.
 - B) idiotism.
 - C) Marinism.
 - D) regionalism.
 - E) solecism.
2. The novelist, short-story writer, journalist, and recipient of the 1953 Pulitzer Prize for Fiction for his novel *The Old Man and the Sea* is
 - A) William Faulkner.
 - B) F. Scott Fitzgerald.
 - C) Ernest Hemingway.
 - D) J. D. Salinger.
 - E) John Steinbeck.
3. The seventeenth-century American poet who is recognized as the first North American author to be published, the author of the collection titled *The Tenth Muse, Lately Sprung up in America*, is
 - A) Abigail Adams.
 - B) Anne Bradstreet.
 - C) Sarah Kemble Knight.
 - D) Mary Rowlandson.
 - E) Phillis Wheatley.
4. The body of literature that includes the works of John Knox, Adam Smith, David Hume, Sir Walter Scott, Robert Burns, and Hugh MacDiarmid is
 - A) Gallic Literature.
 - B) Irish Literature.
 - C) Jewish-American Literature.
 - D) Scottish Literature.
 - E) Welsh Literature.
5. The frequently ritualized state of being, either metaphorical or literal, on a threshold in space or time where, in anthropological terms, many social meanings congregate is known as (an)
 - A) aesthetic distance.
 - B) alienation effect.
 - C) epiphany.
 - D) liminality.
 - E) luminism.
6. A composition imitating another, usually serious, piece—one that is designed to ridicule a work or its style or author—is known as a
 - A) burlesque.
 - B) diatribe.
 - C) farce.
 - D) hoax.
 - E) parody.
7. **Not** a genre that includes narratives considered to be, in major part, the product of communal composition is the
 - A) art epic.
 - B) folk epic.
 - C) folklore.
 - D) folktale.
 - E) legend.
8. In architecture, in art in general, and in literature specifically, a term that applies to "all the extravagances of an irregular fancy," including whatever is medieval, natural, primitive, wild, and romantic, is
 - A) gazebo.
 - B) gestalt.
 - C) Gongorism.
 - D) gonzoism.
 - E) Gothic.
9. The recipient of three Pulitzer Prizes including the 1943 Pulitzer for Drama for his play *The Skin of Our Teeth* is
 - A) Edward Albee.
 - B) David Mamet.
 - C) Robert E. Sherwood.
 - D) Neil Simon.
 - E) Thornton Wilder.
10. A figure of speech used for so long that it is taken in its denotative sense only, without the conscious comparison to a physical object it once conveyed, is known as a(n)
 - A) archaism.
 - B) dead metaphor.
 - C) false etymology.
 - D) Hobson-Jobson.
 - E) silent correction.

11. The convention much used in verse that rhetorically asks, "Where are those who were before us?" is known as the
 - A) *carpe diem* formula.
 - B) *in medias res* formula.
 - C) *memento mori* formula.
 - D) *ubi sunt* formula.
 - E) *verbum infans* formula.
12. The British author of *The Inheritors*, *Rites of Passage*, and *The Lord of the Flies* (which is ranked among the top British novels of all time) who received the 1983 Nobel Prize for Literature is
 - A) Winston Churchill.
 - B) John Galsworthy.
 - C) William Golding.
 - D) Rudyard Kipling.
 - E) Harold Pinter.
13. The stanzaic form consisting of eight iambic pentameter lines rhyming *abababcc* is the
 - A) octameter.
 - B) octapla.
 - C) octastich.
 - D) *ottava rima*.
 - E) oxytonic verse.
14. The period in English literary history that begins with the First World War and encompasses the Second World War and its aftermath and that is characterized by influential English-language novelists, poets, and playwrights who, while citizens of the British Commonwealth, are not actually English is the
 - A) Modernist Period in English Literature.
 - B) Period of the Confessional Self.
 - C) Post-Modernist or Contemporary Period.
 - D) Realistic Period.
 - E) Romantic Period.
15. The group of British writers in the 1950s and the 1960s who demonstrated a particular bitterness in their attacks on outmoded, bourgeois values is known as the
 - A) Angry Young Men.
 - B) Cockney School.
 - C) Lake School.
 - D) Scriblerus Club.
 - E) Spasmodic School.
16. **Not** a stage found in Freytag's Pyramid, the diagram that reflects the structure of a five-act tragedy is the
 - A) catastrophe.
 - B) climax.
 - C) complications.
 - D) exposition.
 - E) reduplication.
17. Literature in which literary elements—plot, character, and so forth—are subordinate to the direct formulaic expression of moral insight and truth is known as
 - A) comparative literature.
 - B) epistolary literature.
 - C) frontier literature.
 - D) popular literature
 - E) wisdom literature.
18. An article, including any book, that one keeps constantly on hand is called a(n)
 - A) *de casibus*.
 - B) *deus ex machina*.
 - C) *dolce stil nuovo*.
 - D) *in medias res*.
 - E) *vade mecum*.
19. The term applying to women of pronounced intellectual interests and finding popularity after 1750 as a result of its application to a London group of women of literary and intellectual tastes who held assemblies or conversations with literary and ingenious men including Samuel Johnson, David Garrick, and Edmund Burke is
 - A) Bluestockings.
 - B) Lost Generation.
 - C) Parnassians.
 - D) P. E. N.
 - E) Pre-Raphaelites.
20. In its figurative sense, the special usage of a word or words, especially in a developed pattern, often without the conscious knowledge of the author or reader, in which there is a change in basic meanings is
 - A) denotation.
 - B) diction.
 - C) imagery.
 - D) metaphor.
 - E) plain style.

21. The verse form—a favorite of Chaucer that did not come into its greatest popularity until John Dryden and later as a fixed form in poetic expression with Alexander Pope—that is comprised of iambic pentameter lines rhymed in pairs is known as (the)
A) blank verse.
B) heroic couplet.
C) heroic line.
D) projection verse.
E) sapphic stanza.
22. The period in English literature in which prose, including satire and the essay, flourished and which spanned the years 1660-1798, thus including the Restoration Age, the Augustan Age, and the Age of Johnson, is known as the
A) Contemporary Period.
B) Modernist Period.
C) Neoclassic Period.
D) Realistic Period.
E) Romantic Period.
23. The British (Irish) novelist and philosopher who wrote *A Severed Head*, *The Black Prince*, *Nuns and Soldiers*, and *The Good Apprentice* is
A) Isabella Augusta, Lady Gregory.
B) Elizabeth Bowen.
C) Sinéad McCoole.
D) Iris Murdoch.
E) Edna O'Brien.
24. **Not** one of eighteenth-century England's neoclassical poets whose writing emulated either or both classical writing and French neoclassical writing in style and subject matter is
A) Joseph Addison.
B) Robert Browning.
C) John Dryden.
D) Alexander Pope.
E) Jonathan Swift.
25. A term for writing distinguished by its classical refinement, its intellectual sharpness, and its elegant but stinging wit is
A) agitprop.
B) attic salt.
C) bout-rimés.
D) purple patch.
E) touchstone.
26. An eighteenth-century philosophical movement that gave shape to the American Revolution and the two basic documents of the United States, the Declaration of Independence and the Constitution, is the
A) Arts and Crafts Movement.
B) Commonwealth (or Puritan) Interregnum.
C) Enlightenment.
D) Great Awakening.
E) Renaissance.
27. A work of fiction characteristically involving military or paramilitary characters in far-fetched adventures centering on advanced equipment including weaponry, computers, space apparatus, and vehicles is known as a(n)
A) adventure story.
B) dystopian novel.
C) epistolary novel.
D) techno-thriller.
E) utopian novel.
28. The renowned poet and teacher of poets who was awarded the 1954 Pulitzer for Poetry for his collection titled *The Waking: Poems 1933-1953* is
A) Stephen Vincent Benét.
B) William Rose Benét.
C) Robert Frost.
D) Robert Lowell.
E) Theodore Roethke.
29. A term—synonymous with the frequently used term chronicle play—that denotes any drama whose time setting is in some period earlier than that in which it is written is
A) closet drama.
B) history play.
C) problem play.
D) satirical play.
E) satyr play.
30. The twentieth-century Chinese-American author of the multi-award winning *The Joy Luck Club*, *Sagwa*, *The Chinese-Siamese Cat*, and *Saving Fish from Drowning* is
A) Maxine Hong Kingston.
B) Michelle Kwan.
C) Ursula Le Guin.
D) Amy Tan.
E) Gao Xingjian.

Part 2: The UIL Reading List

20 items (2 points each)

Items 31-35 are associated with Eugene O'Neill's *The Iceman Cometh*.

Items 36-42 are associated with Harper Lee's *To Kill a Mockingbird*.

Items 43-50 are associated with William Shakespeare's sonnets.

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31. In Eugene O'Neill's *The Iceman Cometh*, the phrase, as delivered by Don Parritt to Rocky Pioggi, "I'm on the wagon" means that he is
- A) abstaining from alcohol.
 - B) heading to jail.
 - C) heading westward.
 - D) joining the circus.
 - E) rolling to victory.
32. Willie Oban's declaration to Parritt that he "was born in the purple" is an idiom that when understood in terms of the setting in which he finds himself means that Willie was born into (a/the)
- A) Alice Walker's neighborhood.
 - B) family of the Shiny Charizard.
 - C) relative wealth.
 - D) Women's Suffrage Movement.
 - E) world of pain and suffering.
33. Harry Hope derides the two detectives Moran and Lieb, saying, "[Y]ou know the old story, when St. Patrick drove the snakes out of Ireland they swam to New York" where they joined the
- A) Industrial Workers of the World.
 - B) Pinkerton Detective Agency.
 - C) Pipe Dreamers of the World.
 - D) police force.
 - E) Survivors of the Great Hunger.
34. Slade's snide observation to Cora, "Be God, it's a second feast of Belshazzar, with Hickey to do the writing on the wall!" constitutes a
- A) biblical allusion.
 - B) classical allusion.
 - C) mythological allusion.
 - D) pop culture allusion.
 - E) topical allusion.
35. Parritt, speaking to Larry, says "I hung around [places] where they'd never look for a Wobbler," which is someone associated with the
- A) Catholic Worker Movement.
 - B) Industrial Workers of the World.
 - C) Knights of Labor.
 - D) Luddites.
 - E) World of Weebles.
36. In Harper Lee's *To Kill a Mockingbird*, the neighbor whose image, according to the narrator, "blurred with [Scout's] sudden tears" is
- A) Maudie Atkinson.
 - B) Horace Gilmore.
 - C) Arthur Radley.
 - D) Nathan Radley.
 - E) Heck Tate.
37. The youngster responding to Miss Fisher's directive, declaring, "You ain't sendin' me home, missus. I was on the verge of leavin'—I done done my time for this year" is the cootie-laden Ewell known at home as
- A) Burris.
 - B) Cecil.
 - C) Charles.
 - D) Nathan.
 - E) Walter.
38. "Jem and [Scout] were burdened with the guilt of contributing to the aberrations of nature, thereby causing unhappiness to our neighbors and discomfort to ourselves," according to Mr. Avery's reading of (the)
- A) *Bullfinch's Mythology*.
 - B) *The Gray Ghost*.
 - C) *Ivanhoe*.
 - D) *Old Farmer's Almanac*.
 - E) Rosetta Stone.
39. Miss Maudie's chastising questions, "Well now, Miss Jean Louise, [. . .] still think your father can't do anything? Still ashamed of him?" follow Atticus Finch's
- A) defending Tom Robinson.
 - B) passing the bar exam.
 - C) shooting a mad dog.
 - D) winning a Pulitzer Prize.
 - E) winning the Robinson case.
40. The argument that transpires between Atticus and Aunt Alexandra while Jem reads a sports magazine on the couch and Scout is in the bathroom concerns
- A) Avery's odd behavior.
 - B) Burris's case of cooties.
 - C) Calpurnia's continued employment.
 - D) Dill's summer visits.
 - E) Ewell's treatment of his own children.

41. Both Atticus's and Alexandra's given names are significant in that each name reflects something about its bearer's character; the term for this significant relationship is
- A) Homeric epithet.
 - B) intentional fallacy.
 - C) onomatopoeia.
 - D) *redende name*.
 - E) transferred epithet.
42. Scout recounts that the evidence "would tend to show that a left-handed person did it"; she continues, "Sherlock Holmes and Jem Finch would agree." This yoking of two dissimilar items—in this case two people with differing levels of authority—should be recognized as a case of
- A) chiasmus.
 - B) hypallage.
 - C) literary allusion.
 - D) poetic license.
 - E) syllepsis.

Items 43-50 refer to William Shakespeare's

"[Look in thy glass and tell the face . . .]"

Look in thy glass and tell the face thou viewest,
 Now is the time that face should form another,
 Whose fresh repair if now thou not renewest,
 Thou dost beguile the world, unbless some mother. 4
 For where is she so fair whose unear'd womb
 Disdains the tillage of thy husbandry?
 Or who is he so fond will be the tomb
 Of his self-love, to stop posterity? 8
 Thou art thy mother's glass, and she in thee
 Calls back the lovely April of her prime;
 So thou through windows of thine age shalt see,
 Despite of wrinkles, this thy golden time. 12
 But if thou live rememb'rd not to be,
 Die single, and thine image dies with thee.

43. In William Shakespeare's Sonnet 3 "[Look in thy glass and tell the face thou viewest]" the speaker's addressing directly the non-responsive (within the poem) audience throughout the poem (lines 1, 4, 9, 13) is known as a(n)
- A) apostrophe.
 - B) aside.
 - C) breaking the fourth wall.
 - D) harangue.
 - E) soliloquy.
44. Line 1's opening imperative "Look in thy glass and tell the face thou viewest" and the third quatrain's softer declarative "Thou art thy mother's glass" (9) both refer to a
- A) face.
 - B) genealogy.
 - C) memory.
 - D) mirror.
 - E) window.
45. The rhyme scheme characterizing the sonnet's first quatrain—viewest / renewest (lines 1 and 3); another / mother (lines 2 and 4), each pairing featuring both compound rhyme and double rhyme, both of which should be scanned as having an unstressed eleventh syllable of a line of iambic pentameter—is best known as
- A) beginning rhyme.
 - B) feminine rhyme.
 - C) leonine rhyme.
 - D) masculine rhyme.
 - E) true rhyme.
46. Line 4's *beguile* means to
- A) charmingly deny.
 - B) charmingly dismiss.
 - C) coyly placate.
 - D) coyly charm.
 - E) dismissively unbless.
47. Line 6's *husbandry* is
- A) agricultural economy.
 - B) cryptic plowing.
 - C) matrimonial uncertainty.
 - D) posterity's potential.
 - E) spousal disdain.
48. The sonnet's volta occurs at the beginning of
- A) line 7.
 - B) line 11.
 - C) line 12.
 - D) line 13.
 - E) line 14.
49. Lines 5 and 6 constitute (a/n)
- A) equivoque.
 - B) personification.
 - C) prosopopoeia.
 - D) rhetorical accent.
 - E) rhetorical question.

50. The speaker's use of *fond* (line 7) is best understood in terms of the auditor's
- A) fresh repair (line 3).
 - B) lovely April (line 10).
 - C) self-love (line 8).
 - D) unneared womb (line 5).
 - E) wrinkles (line 12).

Part 3: Ability in Literary Criticism
15 items (2 points each)

Items 51-56 refer to Thomas Hardy's

The Darkling Thrush *

I leant upon a coppice gate
 When Frost was spectre-grey,
 And Winter's dregs made desolate
 The weakening eye of day. 4
 The tangled bine-stems scored the sky
 Like strings of broken lyres,
 And all mankind that haunted nigh
 Had sought their household fires. 8

The land's sharp features seemed to be
 The Century's corpse outleant,
 His crypt the cloudy canopy,
 The wind his death-lament. 12
 The ancient pulse of germ and birth
 Was shrunken hard and dry,
 And every spirit upon earth
 Seemed fervourless as I. 16

At once a voice arose among
 The bleak twigs overhead
 In a full-hearted evensong
 Of joy illimited; 20
 An aged thrush, frail, gaunt, and small,
 In blast-beruffled plume,
 Had chosen thus to fling his soul
 Upon the growing gloom. 24

So little cause for carolings
 Of such ecstatic sound
 Was written on terrestrial things
 Afar or nigh around, 28
 That I could think there trembled through
 His happy good-night air
 Some blessed Hope, whereof he knew
 And I was unaware. 32

*a song bird

51. The stanza form to which Thomas Hardy's "The Darkling Thrush" adheres is
- A) common meter.
 - B) heroic stanza.
 - C) long measure.
 - D) Poulter's measure.
 - E) short measure.
52. Line 4's "weakening eye of day" is the
- A) desolate coppice.
 - B) grey dregs.
 - C) rising moon.
 - D) sun.
 - E) thrush's eye.
53. Line 6's comparison begins with a
- A) Homeric simile.
 - B) simile.
 - C) synecdoche.
 - D) tautology.
 - E) transferred epithet.
54. Line 9's compression of consonant sounds into single sounds as in land's ssharp and features sseemed is
- A) chiasmus.
 - B) litotes.
 - C) syzygy.
 - D) transverse alliteration.
 - E) zeugma.
55. "His crypt the cloudy canopy" (line 11) features
- A) alliteration.
 - B) assonance.
 - C) consonance.
 - D) dissonance.
 - E) sigmatism.
56. The melopoeic sibilant repetition in line 17 is called
- A) alliteration.
 - B) assonance.
 - C) consonance.
 - D) dissonance.
 - E) sigmatism.

Items 57-61 refer to Edna St. Vincent Millay's
Love Is Not All

Love is not all: it is not meat nor drink
 Nor slumber nor a roof against the rain;
 Nor yet a floating spar* to men that sink *pole
 And rise and sink and rise and sink again; 4
 Love can not fill the thickened lung with breath,
 Nor clean the blood, nor set the fractured bone;
 Yet many a man is making friends with death
 Even as I speak, for lack of love alone. 8
 It well may be that in a difficult hour,
 Pinned down by pain and moaning for release,
 Or nagged by want past resolution's power,
 I might be driven to sell your love for peace, 12
 Or trade the memory of this night for food.
 It well may be. I do not think I would.

57. The form of Millay's poem is the
 A) Italian sonnet.
 B) Occitan sonnet.
 C) Shakespearean sonnet.
 D) Spenserian sonnet.
 E) terza rima sonnet.
58. Millay's use of more conjunctions than is normal is an example of the scheme
 A) conjunctivitis.
 B) interpolation.
 C) polyhyphenation.
 D) polyptoton.
 E) polysyndeton.
59. Line 7's "making friends with death" is a fine example of the use of
 A) euhemerism.
 B) euphemism.
 C) euphonism.
 D) euphuism.
 E) promiscuity.
60. The poem's tone suggests a playful type of
 A) cynicism.
 B) hedonism.
 C) pragmatism.
 D) romanticism.
 E) vorticism.
61. Contrasting love to a floating spar (lines 1-4) is a
 A) conceit.
 B) metaphor.
 C) paradox.
 D) simile.
 E) tautology.

Items 61-65 refer to Oscar Wilde's

Impression du Matin*

The Thames nocturne of blue and gold
 Changed to a Harmony in grey:
 A barge with ochre-coloured hay
 Dropt from the wharf: and chill and cold 4
 The yellow fog came creeping down
 The bridges, till the houses' walls
 Seemed changed to shadows and St. Paul's
 Loomed like a bubble o'er the town. 8
 Then suddenly arose the clang
 Of waking life; the streets were stirred
 With country waggons: and a bird
 Flew to the glistening roofs and sang. 12
 But one pale woman all alone,
 The daylight kissing her wan hair,
 Loitered beneath the gas lamps' flare,
 With lips of flame and heart of stone. 16

*impression of the morning

62. Wilde's description of a London morning addresses most of the senses; however, the pervasive imagery remains
 A) auditory.
 B) gustatory.
 C) olfactory.
 D) tactile.
 E) visual.
63. The first stanza presents color patterns in terms of sound; describing of one kind of sensation in terms of another is
 A) chiaroscuro.
 B) montage.
 C) mosaic.
 D) synæsthesia.
 E) synecdoche.
64. Line 9's *clang* is an example of
 A) dissonance.
 B) onomatopoeia.
 C) pun.
 D) synæsthesia.
 E) wrenched accent.
65. The poem's basic metrical pattern is
 A) iambic pentameter.
 B) iambic tetrameter.
 C) spondaic pentameter.
 D) trochaic pentameter.
 E) trochaic tetrameter.

Required Tie-Breaking Essay

Note well: Contestants who do not write an essay will be disqualified even if they are not involved in any tie. Any essay that does not demonstrate a sincere effort to discuss the assigned topic will be disqualified. The judge(s) should note carefully this criterion when breaking ties: ranking of essays for tie-breaking purposes should be based primarily on how well the topic has been addressed.

Three sheets of paper have been provided; your written response should reflect the *Handbook's* notion that an essay is a "moderately brief discussion of a restricted topic": something more than just a few sentences.

Read William Shakespeare's "[Where art thou, muse, that thou forget'st so long]" (Sonnet 100), and offer a discussion **regarding the relationship between the speaker in the poem and the muse**, however it is to be understood, including, perhaps, the speaker's own imagination and **especially in terms of diction choice**.

[Where art thou, Muse, that thou forget'st so long]

Where art thou, Muse, that thou forget'st so long	
To speak of that which gives thee all thy might?	
Spend'st thou thy fury* on some worthless song,	* poetic inspiration
Dark'ning thy power to lend base subjects light?	4
Return, forgetful Muse, and straight redeem	
In gentle numbers* time so idly spent;	* poetry
Sing to the ear that doth thy lays* esteem	* poems, songs
And gives thy pen both skill and argument.	8
Rise, resty* Muse, my love's sweet face survey,	* idle, perhaps lazy
If* Time have any wrinkle graven there;	* read: <i>to discover whether</i>
If any, be a satire to decay,	* satirist of decay
And make Time's spoils despisèd everywhere.	12
Give my love fame faster than Time wastes life;	
So thou prevent'st* his scythe and crookèd knife.	* forestalls

DO NOT DISTRIBUTE THIS **KEY** TO STUDENTS BEFORE OR DURING THE CONTEST.

UIL Literary Criticism
Invitational B • 2026

line arrows up ➔

1.	A	96
2.	C	602
3.	B	97
4.	D	435
5.	D	273
6.	E	353
7.	A	41
8.	E	220
9.	E	607
10.	B	130
11.	D	489
12.	C	600
13.	D	343
14.	A	305
15.	A	29
16.	E	404
17.	E	504
18.	E	493
19.	A	62
20.	C	246
21.	B	230
22.	C	320
23.	D	588
24.	B	161, 401
25.	B	45
26.	C	174
27.	D	474
28.	E	604
29.	B	235
30.	D	592

31.	A	23
32.	C	35
33.	D	206
34.	A	105
35.	B	27
36.	C	310
37.	A	30
38.	E	72
39.	C	111
40.	C	155
41.	D	403
42.	E	202; 466
43.	A	37
44.	D	
45.	B	196
46.	A	
47.	A	
48.	D	
49.	E	412
50.	C	
51.	A	101
52.	D	
53.	B	445
54.	C	471
55.	A	13
56.	E	
57.	C	442
58.	E	373
59.	B	186
60.	C	377
61.	B	294
62.	E	
63.	D	469
64.	B	337
65.	B	

FOLD

along the **three**
longitudinal
lines for ease
in grading. ➔

Please note that the objective
scores should not be altered to
reflect the breaking of any ties.

Simply adjust ranking.

The thirty items in Part 1
are worth one point each.

The twenty items in Part 2
are worth two points each.

The fifteen items in Part 3
are worth two points each.

DO NOT
mark (cross out)
actual **LETTER** answer;
mark the answer **NUMERAL**.

Page numbers refer
to the *Handbook 12e*,

W. W. Norton
The Iceman Cometh,

HarperPerennial
To Kill a Mockingbird,
and

Folger Library
Shakespeare's Sonnets, Poems

Part 4: Tie-Breaking Essay

These notes are not intended to be understood as a key for the Tie-Breaking Essay prompt; rather, they should serve the judge(s) as a presentation of critical ideas that might appear in an essay responding to the prompt.

Criteria for judging the Tie-Breaking Essay **SHOULD** include

- the degree to which the instructions have been followed,
- the quality of the critical insight offered in response to the selection,
- the overall effectiveness of the written discussion, and
- the grammatical correctness of the essay.

Note well that the quality of the contestant's critical insight is more important than the contestant's prose style. In short, the Literary Criticism contest is one that promotes the critical analysis of literature. The quality of the writing, which should never go unappreciated, does not trump evidence of critical analysis.

Critical Notes on William Shakespeare's Sonnet 100

Literary concepts that MIGHT be used by the contestant in a discussion of the **relationship between the speaker** in William Shakespeare's Sonnet 100 "[Where art thou, muse, that thou forget'st so long]" **and the muse** whom he addresses, however the concept muse is to be understood, including, perhaps, as the speaker's own imagination, include, **especially in terms of diction choice**,

alliteration,	eternizing/immortalizing,	numbers,
apostrophe,	hyperbole,	paragoge,
assonance,	iambic pentameter,	personification,
chiasmus,	imagination,	rhetorical question,
consonance,	inversion,	rhyme scheme,
diction,	lay,	sigmatism,
elision,	metonymy,	simile, and
epenthesis,	muse,	tone.

The strong response should note the shifts (notably subtle) in the speaker's tone while he addresses, (perhaps cajoles) his muse: "Where art thou" (fairly neutral); "Spend'st how thy fury" (sarcastic); "Return, forgetful Muse" (placating); "Rise, resty Muse" (accusatory); "be a satire" and "make Time's spoils" (commanding); "Give my love" (invoking). The young writer might approach their analysis-becomes-discussion through a *Handbook* understanding of the concept muse and her (classically defined) "responsibility. **This approach more than suffices.**

Either or both a familiarity with post-classical literature (and other artistic expression) or a close read will have the LitCritic recognizing the speaker-as-poet's use of *muse* is in terms of the speaker's own imagination or poetic talent—not the supernaturally-sourced divine afflatus so long in vogue. Thus any recognition that the first quatrain's rhetorical questions should—not must—point to the speaker's effectively addressing himself, which might preclude the sonnet's being an apostrophe; however . . .

The competitor should address the speaker's seeking inspiration and his chiding his muse for wasting time on poetry ("song" line 3) that celebrates something of lesser worth than the most deserving object of the speaker-as-poet's interrupted flow of praise (see closing couplet). The speaker, however, might be losing interest in this particular object of praise and is choosing to blame his imagination.

The tonal shift in diction choice, the young writer might note, progresses through the poem (see first paragraph) toward a classically phrased invocation ("Give . . .") that is, indeed, the closing couplet.

The competitor might choose to address the speaker's request (lines 9-14) to eternize/to immortalize/to memorialize the beauty of the person with whom the speaker is—or was—so infatuated.